

SPIRITUAL AND EMOTIONAL HEALTH THROUGH RESTITUTION FOR REAL GUILT

Greetings, my dearest friends. Divine blessings and love are with you tonight, and on this path all the way. I welcome also the new friends who are here tonight for the first time. To them I should like to say that this lecture may not be easy to follow, especially if the previous lectures are not known and understood. Even then it would not be easy to really follow because this material is particularly directed to areas and levels of the psyche that are accessible only after certain blocks and obstructions have been dissolved by this work. My friends who are on this path have taken considerable time in doing very intensive work and have thereby reached these accessible areas. Hence, my words can by-pass mere intellectual understanding. Nevertheless, it may be that the new friends may feel an echo here or there in their souls, which may then give them the incentive to start a similar road of self-finding. This is not as easy and painless as it may appear, yet it is really the only way that leads to fulfillment.

Let us now continue. In my last lecture, we discussed real guilt. Quite a long time ago, I discussed real guilt versus false guilt, but at that time it was not possible to go into that subject in more detail because you were not ready then, my friends. Many areas of your psychic life had to be explored and understood before it was possible to face and come to terms with the real guilts that always lie behind the false ones.

However, not all of my old friends will immediately be able to go into this phase of the pathwork. But sooner or later you will come to this point, provided you proceed in your sincere endeavors. Once you have groped your way through the maze of your various images and misconceptions, then you will be able to come face to face with your real guilts.

In all the time we have spent together, we have, so far, gone through two major phases. Of course, there are some subdivisions, but in a brief overall review, it will be seen that when we first started, I told you about the importance of man purifying himself -- that this indeed is the real meaning of life and the way of fulfilling himself. Then there came the next phase in which quite deliberately we shied away from even using such a word as purification. In this phase, we were concerned with looking at the self without the thought of "right" or "wrong." Often I stated that there was a good reason for this, but I do not believe that the majority of you really understood the reason. Perhaps now you will understand.

Perhaps the most difficult thing for man is that of facing his lower self. And, after all, it is in connection with the lower self that real guilt exists. Man goes to any length to avoid facing the lower self. Or perhaps he is capable of and willing to face parts of it, yet certain parts he is absolutely unwilling to accept. He is so frightened by the possible implications and so eager to be better than he can possibly be at the moment, that he would rather produce much worse guilts that are untrue than accept the tiniest real guilt belonging to the area of the lower self that he is unwilling

to accept. This condition is quite general and very important to recognize. It is still vastly underestimated.

In order to make man capable of facing his lower self in its entirety, he has first to learn to accept and to forgive himself. For that very reason, we remained for a considerable time in what we might term the second major phase on our path together. This means to recognize and then to stop the tendency to moralize with oneself, to understand the harm of perfectionism. This may seem quite paradoxical. For on the one hand, I invite you to face your lower self, your real guilts, and to make restitution for them, to purify yourself; while on the other, I emphasize how dangerous perfectionism, self-condemnation, moralizing, false guilt feelings are.

You see, my dearest friends, to the degree that this perfectionism and self-condemnation exist, to that degree you cannot accept your lower self. For in that perfectionism, as I said many times before, you will drive yourself into a false perfection that is superimposed and therefore destructive. Only when you have the courage and humility to be what you are, to calmly accept yourself as you are, will you have the resiliency to accept the lower self as it actually is, to accept the real guilts and then make up for them. This then makes it possible to accept your real values, to even become profoundly aware of them. This is why it is so important -- as long as one deals with these respective personality levels -- to shy away from any implications of sinfulness, from anything that might even remotely appear as condemnation on my part so as not to encourage this tendency in yourself.

On the whole, you are ready now to proceed a step further. When I say that, it includes the variations of time, even up to a few months or even a year. One person may be very near the phase now in which he has become organically ready to face his real guilts, while another may still be struggling to come to terms with his false guilts; with his tendency to condemn himself; with his weaknesses and the paralysis of his faculties; with his false impressions and concepts; and even with the opposite of self-condemnation, namely self-justification; his accusation of others; or even the often real weakness that allows others to exploit and take advantage of him. This inability to assert himself, to stand up for his rights, may appear to be the very opposite of evil. Even if you have recognized that this is unhealthy, emotionally you cannot yet experience that such paralysis is very much connected with unrecognized facets of the lower self, with real guilt. So those friends who are still involved in this phase of self-exploration and are therefore not yet quite ready to come to this deeper core, they too will soon be ready if only they persevere. But before this readiness manifests naturally in the private work, to attempt this facing of real guilt by mere force would either find you completely closed up, or it might crush you.

The resiliency of accepting your lower self in all its aspects can be cultivated even before your personal pathwork leads you to it. It is not as difficult to come by as my earlier words may indicate. Self-exploration and facing lesser "evils" make the psyche strong enough to face very unflattering truths. However, this strength can be cultivated by the right kind of meditation and thought process and the proper self-observation as to your reaction whenever you come close to this phase. When you observe your oversensitivity in this regard, how easily hurt you are, your temptation to pamper yourself by the very strong reaction of hurt you produce, then you have an indication of how you, too, shy away from fully facing your lower self.

Here, it is a question of saying to yourself: "Do I wish to pamper myself? Do I wish to be in self-pity? Or can I just calmly look at myself with the negative tendencies that side by side exist with

the constructive ones?" If this wish is cultivated, daily uttered, and sincerely meant, your extreme reaction to certain destructive tendencies, which so far you only vaguely sense, will give way to calmly looking at yourself from this particular point of view. It is this very attitude that is the prerequisite to creating the resiliency of facing yourself in utter truthfulness. It demands of you the ability not to lose a sense of proportion, or rather the understanding that this is what you tend to do -- lose your sense of proportion. When you approach certain trends you are not ready to accept in yourself, you produce, almost artificially, as it were, an overreaction of despair, hurt, self-abasement, or a feeling of injustice. You no longer realize, although you may do so in your intellect (but this understanding is forgotten), that it is very possible to be a decent and good person on the one hand, while you also are the opposite in some respects. You fluctuate between the two extremes of either being good or being bad, rather than seeing the good and the bad. It is this very "and," instead of "or" you have to keep in mind. If you continue from there on, facing areas of yourself you have never faced before, it will not be a crushing experience at all. It has to come to that, my friends, if you really want to become healthy and strong.

Let us for a moment now consider the corroding effect that not facing the lower self and real guilts has upon your personality, your life, and upon those around you. What traditional psychiatry or psychology today terms neurosis or psychological problems is nothing but this nonfacing and evasion of the lower self. Or, put in different words, it is the area of your being where your integrity is impaired. Unfortunately, this aspect is not sufficiently recognized. But the time will come. Psychology has reached the insight that false guilts are produced, that weakness and paralysis exist, that impairment of inherent productive faculties exist. But it has as yet not, or not fully, understood the underlying cause for these factors, which basically is always the nonfacing of the lower self, the carrying of burdens of unrestituted real guilts.

It is true that this cannot be done unless these other areas have been explored, unless it is found how certain persons tend in the opposite direction of their real guilts by letting themselves be exploited. It is true that if this is done on a superficial level, more harm occurs than good because man's mask self, man's idealized self, man's self-deception have to be eliminated in order to face real guilts productively and with a sense of proportion. Therefore one has to proceed with caution, or rather with the proper timing, in order to approach this deepest cause for human unhappiness and illness of the soul. So long as worldly psychology seeks for other causes than impaired integrity, cures will not really take place, only occasional alleviation of symptoms.

For the group as a whole, the time is now ripe, and some of my friends have made very good beginnings in this direction. They are on the right track, and they need further guidance in order to go through this phase. As I have said, the first step necessary is a concise understanding of what nonfacing of lower self areas does to you. In not facing these areas, you are incapable of dealing with the results of the trends of the lower self in question. Thus you load a double guilt upon yourself: (1) the actual selfishness and lack of love, manifesting in deed, thought, or feeling; (2) the evasion and self-deception and hypocrisy of pretending often the opposite, and therefore your not making restitution for the original fault.

Such a double-edged guilt produces false guilt; a sense of weakness and ineffectiveness; a lack of self-respect with subsequent feelings of insecurity and inferiority -- therefore dependency upon others to restore this damaged self-respect. This dependency weakens, causes submissiveness, and allows the person to be exploited. As you know, all of these tendencies are not out in the open.

They have to be dealt with, explored, and understood in the second major phase. It often takes a considerable length of time to even become aware of the false guilts, let alone the real ones.

The various means you employ to gain acceptance from others, many of which have been found in the course of this work, are always a result of not accepting yourself. It is impossible to do so if you have not come to the very worst in yourself. Only then, as I said, can you accept your whole being; only then will you truly be convinced of the good in you. And you will therefore no longer need others to give you what no one can give you but yourself. This desperate struggle to be accepted by others in lieu of self-acceptance impairs your integrity even further. It always, in some subtle way, causes you to betray yourself and others, to sell your soul, as it were.

Needless to say, such a situation is bound to make you more egocentric, more closed up towards others, to yourself, and to the universal forces. It decreases your awareness of life and reality. It therefore causes you to go through life with closed eyes and bound hands and feet. In short, it cripples the best in you that could only begin to truly unfold if you stop this self-evasion. It prohibits the capacity to communicate and to love, or it impairs or dilutes this capacity. On the one hand, this capacity is there by nature; while on the other hand, your evasion cripples its unfoldment. Therefore you are inwardly torn in two directions. This inner conflict confuses you because you are not aware of its real cause. The result is imbalance. You either lean over backwards to allow others to take advantage of you as a false way to atone for the real guilt. Or you become defensive and defiant because you vaguely feel guilt, yet you cannot put your finger on it. You do not know why you should feel that way and thus become angry at yourself and the world for these vague pangs of conscience.

If you take any of the aspects we have worked through in the last few years and try to link them up with what I am saying tonight, you will gain a much profounder understanding of these psychological aspects. Self-respect and self-assurance can only exist if you do not hide from your impaired integrity. When you come courageously face to face with that part in yourself, you will repair damage that cannot otherwise be repaired. In order to muster up the necessary courage and concentration, you have to understand fully the corroding effect on your life of the best that is in you. This will give you the incentive.

When I say incentive, what do I mean? You hear it in a lecture, and, somehow, you wait vaguely for something to happen, never realizing that you are in the driver's seat if only you take the wheel. This happens by looking at your reactions. You can use all of your efforts, your will, your concentration, and your acute self-observation so as to detect the fine, and sometimes not even subtle, reactions of shying away from facing yourself in this touchy area. This observation will enable you to remove the blindfolds which are not at all unconscious. They manifest in many ways, every day. If you will just point your finger at them, you will by that very action remove them. By having the incentive, I mean just this attitude of discovering your disproportionate hurt from any suggestion of certain negative trends, your disproportionate fear and rebellion against such implications coming from others or yourself or simply through certain events of your daily living -- also your disproportionate reaction that now you are no good, which might not be thought of in these exact terms, but translating your emotions, this is what it amounts to.

Now let us consider the subsequent step in this direction. Once you have arrived at this healthy self-acceptance in which you fully face your real guilts and certain hitherto hidden aspects of

your lower self, what then? It is not sufficient merely to recognize it although, of course, it is the first necessary step in this particular phase. In order to enable you to go through this first step, you have to know, again and again, that you are not forced to take any action, to make any change that you are not wholeheartedly willing to undertake. Not because I say so or because some spiritual law exists is it that you are not forced to do something. Such obedience is not a free action that can possibly produce any constructive effects. But the time will come when you will want to undertake such actions of making good. You will truly want to even though it may mean overcoming a certain resistance. So begin by penetrating the wall of evasion through the realization that you are a free agent; that you should act only if such action is freely chosen; that it is better to see and refrain than not to see and refrain from good action. It is very important for you to know that you are not being punished by knowing and not acting on this knowledge. But sufficient awareness will eventually make you wish to go through the action that restitutes past guilt.

What I will say now is applicable for the time when you have seen and, in full independent freedom, have arrived at the stage when you wish to make restitution. In fact, when this stage arrives through the process of organic growth and development, such a possibility will be a welcome way out for you. Without this possibility, you may remain in despair because you falsely believe that wrongs cannot be made good, that they are unattonable. This is often an unconscious reason for not facing the guilt. One can make restitution when one really wants to. Now, how can this be done? There is no ready-made formula. There never can be for a reality which is dynamic and knows infinite varieties. Restitution is comparatively easy for clear-cut actions and incidents of wrongs that have been inflicted. But it is not so easy for the subtlety of attitudes and emotional reactions. In the former case, atonement can take place, for example, by talking to the wronged person in candor. This in itself may take away the wrong because the other person will no longer feel unjustly treated, confused, disharmonious. In other instances, in addition to talking, certain productive actions may be indicated that will come to your mind when you search in a spirit of sincerity rather than in a spirit of superficiality and glib cheap disposal of a duty done. In both cases -- only talking it out or talking it out with subsequent action -- it will relieve a bleeding heart, a festering sore. Beware of undertaking any actions before you are fully convinced and desirous of doing so. Ask for the how in prayer, and open yourself. When you are fully aware of the pain you may have inflicted on others, your desire will be strong enough to remove that pain, and then you will also find the right way. But as long as you do not want to face the pain you have inflicted, you cannot truly want to make good for it. And, furthermore, because you do not want to become aware of inflicted pain, you do not want to face your lower self in its entirety.

When issues are not clear-cut, when it is a question of subtle emotions, of indirect results such as, for instance, your withholding and withdrawing, even then you will find ways to know how to make up for committed wrongs. You can inflict pain by not daring to give of yourself, of your best (due to fear, cowardice, pride, betrayal, misconceptions), thus leaving others in need, and increasing their sense of unworthiness. These subtle effects are more difficult to determine and are also not as simple to make restitution for. But if your heart is sincere and if through all these stages I have led you through you have come to the point you will have a deep desire. That very desire, uttered in prayer and meditation, will make you find the way. Even if you no longer have the opportunity to make good with the same person you have shortchanged, the cultivation of the very ability of giving your best rather than deliberately hampering it, as before, will make for restitution! If others now profit from this new-found ability, it too is restitution! You will deeply feel the truth of this. If you

voluntarily give up the wall of isolation and thus let the richness of your inherent being stream onto others, it is restitution.

In short, my friends, two major steps are necessary for you to free yourselves of the crippling effects of real guilts and unrecognized aspects of the lower self. One is finding and facing these aspects, calmly and proportionately viewing these aspects, without self-condemnation or self-justification, yet fully taking responsibility for any wrong you have inadvertently done, directly or indirectly, by commission or omission. It is necessary to penetrate through all the false guilts, through the paralysis and the weakness and the areas where you are exploited, and which you consider a neurosis -- which it is even if it is only an effect and not the cause -- until you come to face areas you have kept "private" so far. And the second major step is the restitution, which is often subdivided into two parts: the expression of it to another human being and ceasing to carry it alone, and the finding of a way to make good and to atone.

If this is done, my dearest friends -- and again, it is not one simple act, but a constant process of growing and of increased awareness -- the growing selfhood and sense of your integrity, the self-respect that must be the inevitable result, will give you forces and strength such as you have never known to exist. It will enable you to become independent of this dire need for recognition by others which makes you sell your soul. This will give you the ability to freely express yourself without inhibition, with your best faculties right at your disposal; to communicate and relate; to assert your rights without the gnawing feeling that you have not really conveyed that which you wish to be understood. This will give you a new energy and vitality in your daily life that will make you capable of fully living. It will also provide you with the stamina, flexibility, and resiliency to meet life in all its aspects -- making the best of difficulties and fully enjoying life's offerings. In other words, my dear ones, this indeed is the final cure of the soul. Needless to say, it is not easily come by. It will take considerable time to get all of you through in the face of all the temptations of deviation, of all the little byways. But I am here with help. The guidance is here. Knowing this, you can indeed rejoice, for this brings you closer to the threshold.

And now, my dear ones, I'm ready for your questions.

QUESTION: We had a discussion about blessings. We need your help to understand. What are blessings?

ANSWER: The easiest way to explain this in human terms would be to choose the word wish -- a strong, sincere wish. This is much more than you can see at the moment. Imagine that you have a very strong wish that is absolutely unhampered by selfish motives; by ambiguous, confused, contradictory emotions; by uncertainty or fear or the slightest gnawing feeling of real or false guilt. The wish is a clear stream without the slightest selfishness. Such a wish is a blessing. Such a crystal clear strength -- undiluted, unconfused, unsplit -- that is a blessing. If a human being were capable of having a wish for someone else in that way, the power and strength he would have upon all those who are only remotely open to receive is something that defies your imagination. Human beings can have such wishes, and therefore give blessings, only by degrees. The receiver may only be able to accept the blessing in parts of his being, while other areas are blocked off. Obstructions, misconceptions, etc., create a wall. But wherever such walls do not exist, this wish would affect him and will work in his psyche. If human beings extend such wishes, as much as they can, this is, as you know, one form of prayer. But with beings who are no longer involved with the heaviness of earth

matter, the wishes are more likely to have this pure strength; and if accepted, if they reach their destination, they can then be utilized for further propagation of love.

QUESTION: Isn't a wish self-will?

ANSWER: Not necessarily.

QUESTION: How does it combine with giving up your wish to the will of God?

ANSWER: If you wish something purely loving and unselfish, it is the will of God. To want to do the will of God must be your wish. It is here like with so much else -- it depends on the how, why, what of the motives. This alone determines its value or lack of it. Nothing in itself is good or bad -- I have said that so often. Why should a wish in itself be something bad? You must wish to be truthful with yourself. You must wish to love. Or you might wish something destructive. Man often stumbles over terminology. There may be a certain group of people who take a word and claim it means just a certain thing. And then, of course, if this word is used in another way, misunderstanding occurs. We are not concerned with that. Think rather of the essence and meaning of the term. Think of wishing in its constructive manifestations, then you will see that it is not necessarily self-will.

QUESTION: Do you mean, if the wish is fulfilled, it is a blessing?

ANSWER: No. I said that if you have a crystal clear wish for someone else, that it is a blessing. Whether or not it is fulfilled is another matter.

QUESTION: And if there is fear behind the wish, that it will not be fulfilled?

ANSWER: Then it is not a blessing. A blessing is a pure wish. It is an active current of energy. Fear denotes selfishness. Wishes are energy currents. The wish of a human being in a state of conflict is thereby counteracted by a contrary feeling which makes the energy current weak. But if the energy current goes in one direction, or predominantly in one direction, then the wish is strong.

QUESTION: In our discussion, the question came up about the blessing given to Jacob and not Esau. Is it possible to convey a blessing to someone who is not ready to receive it?

ANSWER: It depends on the strength. There are different kinds of blessings. Occasionally there are blessings of such high beings with the corresponding spiritual development, with such a tremendous vibration, that their blessings may be able to penetrate walls, psychological walls. Such a penetration may then have the effect on the human being to pull himself together and do that which is necessary to diminish these walls. Blessings of lesser strength and lesser vibration may not be capable of penetrating a fort, but might be able to penetrate paper thin walls. But then it is a question of what the individual does with this impact of strength, with the result of the blessings. It may happen quite often that a person has indeed received the blessings, which he feels by a wonderful feeling of peace, of hope, and of joy. But after the impact is over, the effect has worn off, he goes right back into his rut. He does not use the blessings in the right direction. The world is filled with thoughts and wishes by others. Crosscurrents go on constantly, not only from among

each other, but also from beings of other worlds. When you have a day in which you are in a wonderful mood, you may then have received, unbeknown, such currents of love, such blessings or pure wishes. It is up to you whether you will use this influx or will go back and again find yourself in bleakness, waiting for life, or for blessings, to carry you. Blessings can be given occasionally. All this goes according to certain rhythmic laws in the universe. But in the final analysis, it is man who has to pull himself out of the darkness.

Be blessed, be open, my dearest ones, for the warmth, the strength, the love that is coming to you and through you. May you indeed use this strength for the very purpose of bringing your life into the health that the pathwork of this lecture suggests. What this means is impossible to visualize. Unfortunately most human beings do not know how to cope with the difficulty, or what seems so -- that of facing oneself. This is the very key to happiness that can be yours regardless of who you are, regardless of how difficult your life may be. With this, I bless you again with love. Be in peace. Be in God.

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